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MULTISPECTRAL OPTICAL FINGER SYSTEM FOR PHYSIOLOGICAL MEASUREMENTS

Abstract

Wearable optical devices, methods and systems for obtain dynamic and static physiological parameters from a subject are disclosed. Example devices can be worn around an appendage, such as a finger, and utilize PPG sensors to obtain signals from the appendage. The PPG sensors are positioned to acquire signals suitable to reconstruct an image of the inner appendage using, for example, diffuse optical tomography, to provide additional information. The devices, methods, and systems can obtain dynamic and static physiological parameters and accurate images in real-time.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/418,887, filed Jan. 22, 2024, which claims priority to and the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application No. 63/440, 197, filed Jan. 20, 2023, the contents of each of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

FIELD

[0003] The present disclosure relates to devices, methods, and systems for obtaining biosignals from a patient and reconstructing an image to identify the source of the signal and, specifically, to finger-worn devices that can acquire time-domain-based signals and tomographic-based reconstructions from these signals.

BACKGROUND

[0004] Physiological measurements are an essential hallmark of the healthcare industry. Without the ability to measure dynamic parameters, static parameters, and other physiological parameters in patients, it would be impossible to treat the subjects for diseases and ailments effectively. Recent advances in wearable technology allow monitoring of these physiological measurements outside the clinic, which allows patients to continue with their daily lives while constantly monitoring their health and well-being. The technology also gives physicians the ability to monitor physiological parameters in a patient remotely. One widely used technique for measuring physiological parameters is photoplethysmography (PPG). PPG is the measure of blood volume changes within an area of tissue being probed by a light source, typically a light-emitting diode (LED). PPG signals can be acquired by transmission mode, where the light sources and detector are on the opposite sides of the subject, or reflective mode, where the light sources and detector are on the same side of the subject.

[0005] In clinical applications, PPG signals are acquired from the tip of the finger using transmission mode to measure blood oxygenation and heart rate. Health and fitness trackers often utilize a wrist-worn device to obtain biosignals since such devices can be comfortably worn on the wrist during everyday activities. However, major arteries within the wrist area are deeper within the tissue relative to the finger. Moreover, since the wrist area is denser than the finger and light can only travel a few millimeters, wrist devices are designed to measure PPG signals in reflectance mode. Wearable devices can be positioned at the base of the finger as a ring, but unlike the fingertip, the lower phalanx has a more complicated anatomy with a significant amount of opaque tissue and bone. A challenge to the use of PPG is the arbitrary nature in which signals are acquired. A PPG signal is a combination of all the blood volume changes within an area of tissue, including superficial blood vessels and the major artery in question. To determine the blood volume change of the major artery, the blood volume change of the remaining tissues can be estimated and the results are offset by the estimated amount, which can lead to inaccurate results.

[0006] Diffuse Optical Tomography (DOT) is an optical imaging technique typically used for soft tissue. DOT can be used to isolate major arteries by quantifying total hemoglobin concentration along with oxyhemoglobin and deoxyhemoglobin to identify blood oxygenation levels. This technique can also identify areas of higher concentrations of water and lipids along with measuring blood volume change within a tissue region. Traditional DOT systems use significant power-consuming components, making the system unsuitable for wearable devices, and typically utilize lasers, fiber optic cables, and CCD cameras for detection, which creates high power, relatively high cost, and a large equipment requirements typically placed on a benchtop. DOT systems have been designed for the finger, in particular for investigating the progress of rheumatoid arthritis within the

finger joints, but not for measuring real-time hemodynamics such as blood volume changes. An additional issue with diffuse optics is the inability to resolve the correct image and display accurate changes in hemodynamics. Dependent on the DOT technique, real-time images have not yet been developed due to the complexity of the image reconstruction algorithms.

[0007] Accordingly, there is a need for improved wearable devices, methods, and systems to obtain PPG signals as well as an accurate reconstructed image to isolate the signal from the artery and superficial vessels.

SUMMARY

[0008] Examples of the present disclosure include ring devices that utilize multi-wavelength photoplethysmography (PPG) sensors to obtain biosignals. For instance, due to the complexity and the ability to measure signals in both transmission and reflective modes, example ring devices of the present disclosure can overcome the limitations of known arm, wrist, chest and other finger-based PPG sensors. Furthermore, examples of the present disclosure include devices with dual sensing modes for both dynamic and static measurements along with the ability to measure signals from superficial blood vessels in addition to signals coming from the major arteries. Dynamic measurements can include but are not limited to blood volume changes, hemoglobin concentration changes (e.g. blood oxygenation), blood velocity, pulse wave velocity, and blood flow through the finger. Other dynamic measurements that can be derived from these metrics include but are not limited to heart rate, heart rate variability, respiration rate, blood pressure, arterial and venous blood oxygenation, stroke volume, and cardiac output. Static signals measured via the ring device can include but are not limited to bone and tendon locations, the concentration of fat, and the concentration of water.

[0009] Photoplethysmography (PPG) is the measure of blood volume changes within an area of tissue being probed by a light source, typically a light-emitting diode (LED). In operation, light travels through tissue and is absorbed, reflected, and mostly scattered before it is detected with a photodiode (PD). The resulting signal acquired by the photodiode is a cyclical signal oscillating with the cardiac cycle. An oscillating component of the signal, known as the AC component, originates from the pulsatile arterial blood. The AC component is summed with a large offset related to non-pulsatile arterial blood, venous blood, and other bone and tissue matter, known as the quasi-DC component.

[0010] Examples of the present disclosure utilizes diffuse optical tomography (DOT) systems to create an image of the internal finger and accurately identify the location of major arteries, bones, and tendons. With this information, signals from different areas of interest can be isolated.

[0011] A known challenge with diffuse optical imaging such as DOT is the inability to solve the forward or inverse problems to resolve the correct image and display accurate changes in hemodynamics. The forward problem is summarized as solving the diffuse equation to determine the rate of photons traveling through the tissue, given the optical and physiological properties at each point in the tissue. In contrast, the inverse problem uses measured rates of the photons traveling through the tissue to determine the optical and physiological properties at each point in the tissue. Reconstructing an image by solving the inverse problem is ill-posed, computationally expensive, and undetermined. This is due to the iterative nature of the linear and non-linear approaches for solving the forward and inverse models. Further, without accurate scattering and absorption coefficients, resolving and reconstructing an image displaying accurate blood volume changes is difficult.

[0012] Example systems of the present disclosure include a neural network implementing a forward model to solve the inverse problem. The addition of deep learning provides a computationally inexpensive, real-time solution to the inverse problem to construct an accurate image displaying changes in blood volume and hemoglobin concentrations. The PPG and DOT systems of the present disclosure can accurately identify major vessel location, which can, in turn, provide relative blood volume, and hemoglobin concentration changes along with measurement of

physiological parameters such as heart rate, heart rate variability, respiration rate, and blood oxygenation. Examples of the present disclosure include the ability to measure all of these signals simultaneously to provide additional physiological parameters such as blood velocity, flow rate, pulse wave velocity, cardiac output, blood pressure, and other physiological metrics dependent on hemodynamics. Examples of the present disclosure can reconstruct images and provide physiological parameters to a user in real-time or close to real-time.

[0013] In one aspect, a wearable optical device is disclosed that can include a ring configured to surround an appendage, the ring including an outer surface and an inner surface facing the appendage. The device further includes a plurality of light sources disposed circumferentially about the inner surface and configured to direct light towards the appendage and a plurality of detectors disposed circumferentially about the inner surface, each detector configured to receive light from the appendage, the light being reflected from and/or transmitted through the appendage from at least one of the plurality of light sources. In some embodiments, a circuit board is disposed within the ring and operatively connected to each of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors and the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are configured to operate together to generate data suitable for conducting diffuse optical tomography on the appendage.

[0014] In certain embodiments, the device defines an open position, where the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are disposed proximal to the inner surface, and a closed position, where the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are contacting the appendage, the device being operable to move between the open position and the closed position.

[0015] In certain embodiments, the device further includes a carrier disposed within a recess formed in the inner surface of the ring, the carrier configured to couple the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors to the ring.

[0016] In certain embodiments, each of the plurality of light sources comprises a contact surface configured to contact the appendage and each of the plurality of detectors comprises a contact surface configured to contact the appendage. The plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors can be arranged in pairs and each light source and detector of each pair can be disposed within a common housing. In some embodiments, the device further includes a plurality of biasing mechanisms each configured to bias a respective one of the common housings towards the appendage. Each common housing can be configured to move along a respective radial axis and prevented from rotating relative to the carrier.

[0017] In certain embodiments, the device includes a plurality of pressure sensors, each pressure sensor configured to measure pressure of the appendage against the contact surfaces of at least one of a respective one of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors. The device can further include a plurality of position sensors, each position sensor configured to measure radial deflection of at least one of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors by the appendage.

[0018] In certain embodiments, the plurality of light sources includes eight light sources disposed at equal intervals about the circumference of the inner surface, and the plurality of detectors includes eight detectors disposed at equal intervals about the circumference of the inner surface. In some embodiments, each light source of the plurality of light sources includes an array of light-emitting diodes, each array comprising a plurality of individual light-emitting diodes each configured to emit light in a different wavelength.

[0019] In certain embodiments, the device includes a microcontroller configured to cause the emission of light from each of the plurality of light sources and receive the data from each of the plurality of detectors. The device can further include a wireless transmitter configured to transmit the data. In some embodiments, the device includes at least one of a skin temperature sensor, an ambient temperature sensor, or a sensor configured to measure movement of the device.

[0020] In another aspect, a method of obtaining a signal from a subject is disclosed that can include providing a wearable optical device disposed around an appendage, the device comprising a

plurality of light sources and a plurality of detectors disposed circumferentially around the appendage. The method can further include emitting light from one of the plurality of light sources individually, receiving signals from each of the plurality of detectors, repeating the emitting and receiving for each of the plurality of light sources, and generating data from the received signals, the data being suitable for conducting 2D or 3D diffuse optical tomography on the appendage. [0021] In certain embodiments, the method can further include moving the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors towards the appendage until they contact the appendage. The signals can be received from two or more photodiodes at a time. [0022] In some embodiments, the method can further include receiving by a processor, the data from the device disposed around the appendage, reconstructing an image of the appendage using the data and diffuse optical tomography techniques, isolating a biosignal from an internal structure within the appendage, and providing physiological information based on the biosignal. [0023] In certain embodiments, the biosignal includes a dynamic signal and the physiological information includes at least one of: blood volume changes, blood oxygenation, blood velocity, pulse wave velocity, or blood flow. In some embodiments, the biosignal includes a static signal and the physiological information includes at least one of: bone location, tendon location, fat concentration, or water concentration. [0024] In certain embodiments, the image is reconstructed and the physiological information is provided in real-time. The internal structure can be a main artery of the appendage. In some embodiments, the data is processed using a deep learning model to obtain the reconstructed image of the appendage.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

[0025] FIG. 1A is a front view of one exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device;
[0026] FIG. 1B is an isometric side view of the wearable optical device of FIG. 1A;
[0027] FIG. 1C is a side view of the wearable optical device of FIG. 1A;
[0028] FIG. 2A is an isometric side view of a wearable optical device with a radial adjustment mechanism;
[0029] FIG. 2B is a front view of the wearable optical device of FIG. 2A in an open configuration;
[0030] FIG. 2C is a front view of the wearable optical device of FIG. 2A in a closed configuration;
[0031] FIG. 3A is a front view of one exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device worn on an appendage;
[0032] FIG. 3B is a front view of one exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device worn on an appendage;
[0033] FIG. 3C is a front view of one exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device worn on an appendage;
[0034] FIG. 3D is a front view of one exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device worn on an appendage;
[0035] FIG. 4A is a side view of one exemplary embodiment of a sensor carrier with sensors disposed within the carrier;
[0036] FIG. 4B is an isometric side view of the sensor carrier of FIG. 4A;
[0037] FIG. 5 is an isometric side view of another exemplary embodiment of a wearable optical device;
[0038] FIG. 6A is an isometric side view of one exemplary embodiment of a sensor assembly;
[0039] FIG. 6B is an isometric side view of the sensor assembly of FIG. 6A including tension springs;
[0040] FIG. 7A is an isometric top view of one exemplary embodiment of a sensor interface;

[0041] FIG. 7B is a side view of the sensor interface of FIG. 7A;

[0042] FIG. 8A is a schematic of LED and PD alignment around the circumference of an optical device worn on a proximal phalanx with an estimate of the location of the major anatomical components within the phalanx;

[0043] FIG. 8B is a diagram of one exemplary embodiment of a timing scheme for use in conjunction with the present disclosure;

[0044] FIG. 9 is a schematic of one exemplary embodiment of a central circuit board;

[0045] FIG. 10 is a block diagram of one exemplary embodiment of a circuit system for use within the devices of the present disclosure; and

[0046] FIG. 11 is a block diagram of one exemplary embodiment of a computer system for use in conjunction with the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0047] Certain exemplary embodiments will now be described to provide an overall understanding of the principles of the structure, function, manufacture, and use of the devices, systems, and methods disclosed herein. One or more examples of these embodiments are illustrated in the accompanying drawings. Those skilled in the art will understand that the devices, systems, components related to or otherwise part of such devices, systems, and methods specifically described herein and illustrated in the accompanying drawings are non-limiting embodiments and that the scope of the present disclosure is defined solely by the claims. The features illustrated or described in connection with one embodiment may be combined with the features of other embodiments. Such modifications and variations are intended to be included within the scope of the present disclosure. Some of the embodiments provided for herein may be schematic drawings, including possibly some that are not labeled as such but will be understood by a person skilled in the art to be schematic in nature. They may not be to scale or may be somewhat crude renderings of the disclosed components. A person skilled in the art will understand how to implement these teachings and incorporate them into work systems, methods, and components related to each of the same, provided for herein.

[0048] To the extent the present disclosure includes various terms for components and/or processes of the disclosed devices, systems, methods, and the like, one skilled in the art, in view of the claims, present disclosure, and knowledge of the skilled person, will understand such terms are merely examples of such components and/or processes, and other components, designs, processes, and/or actions are possible. In the present disclosure, like-numbered and like-lettered components of various embodiments generally have similar features when those components are of a similar nature and/or serve a similar purpose. To the extent terms such as front, back, top, bottom, proximal, distal, etc. are used to describe a location of various components of the various disclosures, such usage is by no means limiting, and is often used for convenience when describing various possible configurations.

[0049] Articles “a” and “an” are used herein to refer to one or to more than one (i.e., at least one) of the grammatical object of the article. By way of example, “an element” means at least one element and can include more than one element. “About” is used to provide flexibility to a numerical range endpoint by providing that a given value may be “slightly above” or “slightly below” the endpoint without affecting the desired result. The use herein of the terms “including,” “comprising,” or “having,” and variations thereof, is meant to encompass the elements listed thereafter and equivalents thereof as well as additional elements. As used herein, “and/or” refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items, as well as the lack of combinations where interpreted in the alternative (“or”). Moreover, the present disclosure also contemplates that in some embodiments, any feature or combination of features set forth herein can be excluded or omitted. To illustrate, if the specification states that a system or device comprises components A, B and C, it is specifically intended that any of A, B, or C, or any combination thereof, can be omitted and disclaimed singularly or in any combination, including but

not necessarily with other components (e.g., D, E, etc.).

[0050] Recitation of ranges of values herein are merely intended to serve as a shorthand method of referring individually to each separate value falling within the range, unless otherwise indicated herein, and each separate value is incorporated into the specification as if it were individually recited herein. For example, if a concentration range is stated as 1% to 50%, it is intended that values such as 2% to 40%, 10% to 30%, or 1% to 3%, etc., are expressly enumerated in this specification. These are only examples of what is specifically intended, and all possible combinations of numerical values between and including the lowest value and the highest value enumerated are to be considered to be expressly stated in this disclosure. Unless otherwise defined, all technical terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure belongs.

Wearable Optical Device Examples

[0051] One embodiment of a wearable optical device of the present disclosure is illustrated in FIGS. 1A-1C. FIG. 1A shows a side view of a wearable optical device **100** with a plurality of sensor assemblies **130** positioned within the circumference. Each sensor assembly **130** is configured to measure at least one biosignal. Wearable optical devices of the present disclosure can be generally circular and sized and shaped such that they can be worn comfortably on an appendage of a subject (e.g., a finger or toe). For example, the device **100** of FIGS. 1A-1C is a circular ring shape defining a central opening **112** sized and shaped to receive a finger or other appendage. In other embodiments, the device can be sized to be worn around a wrist. The device **100** includes an outer case **110**. The outer case **110** is ring shaped and defines an outer surface **114** and an inner surface **115** opposing the outer surface **114**. The inner surface **115** is configured to face the skin when worn on an appendage. A recess **116** can be formed within the inner surface **115** and can be configured to receive electronics or other components. The outer case can include two edges, **118**, **118'** joining the outer surface **114** and the inner surface **115**. The edges **118**, **118'** can be curved or beveled. When the device **100** is worn on an appendage, the edges **118**, **118'** contact the skin surface enclosing the space within the recess **116** between the skin, the outer case **110**, and edges **118**, **118'**. As shown in FIG. 1B, a carrier **120** can be disposed within the inner recess **116** of the outer case **110**. The carrier **120** is sized and shaped to fit within the recess of the outer case **110** and configured to secure each sensor assembly **130** within the device **110** at the appropriate position. The outer case **110** has a width W and thickness T sufficient to house internal components while also maintaining a slim profile allowing the device to be comfortably worn on an appendage during daily activities.

[0052] In some embodiments, the outer case **110** can be radially adjustable as shown in FIG. 2A. The adjustability includes movement of the device **100** from an open configuration shown in FIG. 2B to a closed configuration shown in FIG. 2C. In the open configuration, the sensors **130** are in a retracted position that is proximal to the carrier **120** and the outer case **110**. In the closed configuration, the sensor assemblies **130** are in an extended position (e.g., by being moved towards the centerpoint of the central opening **112**). Returning to FIG. 2A, the outer case **110** can include two sections **110s**, **110r** rotatably coupled to each other. The stationary section **110s** can be fixed to the carrier **120** while the rotatable section **110r** is free to rotate around the carrier **120**. The rotatable section **110r** can comprise a majority of the width W of the outer case **110** while the stationary section **110s** comprises an edge of the outer case **110** and a portion of the width W. A cam mechanism can be disposed between the outer case **110** and the carrier **120** such that when the second section **110r** of the outer case is rotated in a first direction R_o , the sensor assemblies **130** are extended towards the centerpoint of the central opening **112**. Inversely, rotating the second section **110r** of the outer case in an opposing direction R_e retracts the sensor assemblies **130** back towards the carrier **120**. Any mechanism capable of translating rotational movement to axial movement can be used to extend and retract the sensor assemblies **130** of the present disclosure.

[0053] As discussed with respect to FIG. 6B, each sensor assembly **130** can include a biasing

mechanism, or other component capable of applying controlled tension, to ensure each sensor assembly **130** is pressed against the appendage when the device **100** is worn in the closed position and the sensor assemblies **130** are extended. The biasing mechanism maintains contact of the sensor assemblies **130** on appendages of varying sizes and geometries. For example, the device **100** can accommodate an appendage **10** with an irregular circular shape as shown in FIG. 3A. With this shape, some of the sensor assemblies such as sensor assembly **130'** can contact the appendage at a shorter distance from the outer case **110** than the other sensor assemblies such as sensor assembly **130**. FIG. 3B shows an example of the device **100** placed on a larger appendage **10'**. FIG. 3C shows the device **100** placed on an elliptical shaped appendage **10''** and FIG. 3D shows the device placed on an irregular elliptical shaped appendage **10'''**. In all of the examples of FIGS. 3A-3D, all of the sensor assemblies **130** contact the appendage regardless of the shape or size of the appendage.

[0054] An embodiment of a sensor carrier **120** that can be disposed within the outer case **110** is illustrated in FIGS. 4A and 4B. As shown, the carrier **120** is a relatively flat ring shaped component sized to fit within the recess **116** of the outer case **110**. In both of the open and closed configurations shown in FIGS. 2B and 2C, the carrier is configured to fit completely within the recess of the outer case such that no portion of the carrier extends beyond the recess **116** and into the central opening **112**. The carrier **120** can include coupling features **122** along its circumference to secure each sensor assembly **130**. In the illustrated example of FIG. 4B, the coupling features **122** are openings configured to receive retainer clips **138** included on the sensor assembly **130** as well as openings to receive guide pins, position sensors, or other components of the sensor assemblies **130** (as shown in FIGS. 6A and 6B). The coupling features **122** can be formed within mounts **124** extending from the inner surface of the carrier **120**.

[0055] In some embodiments, the sensor assemblies **230** are coupled directly to the outer case **210** as shown in FIG. 5. As illustrated, the sensor assembly **230** includes a circuit board **232** secured in slots **222** formed within the outer case **210**. A cover **234** is placed over the sensor circuit boards **232** in each slot **222** to prevent signal interference between each sensor assembly **230**.

Sensor Arrangement Examples

[0056] Examples of the present disclosure include sensor assemblies configured to detect and measure signals suitable for calculating physiological parameters, such as heart rate, heart rate variability, respiration rate, and blood oxygenation. The sensor assemblies disclosed herein include a light source, such as a light-emitting diode (LED), and a light detector, such as a photodiode (PD), each typically mounted to a printed circuit board for sending and receiving electrical signals to and from a central circuit board disposed within the device **100**. An embodiment of a sensor assembly **130** that can be disposed within the device **100** is illustrated in FIGS. 6A-6B. The illustrated sensor assembly **130** includes a sensor interface **140**, which includes the light source and detector (shown in FIG. 7A). The sensor assembly **130** can further include two or more guide pins **132** extending from the back surface **140b** of the sensor interface **140**. In the example illustrated in FIG. 6A, two guide pins **132** are fixed along the length of the interface **140** at a perpendicular angle to the back surface **140b** to keep the sensor interface **140** aligned at a perpendicular angle relative to the carrier **120** as the device **100** moves from an open to a closed configuration. A biasing mechanism, such as tension springs **134** can be disposed around the guide pins **132** to bias the sensor interface **140** towards the appendage. The sensor assembly **130** further includes a position sensor **136** disposed on the back surface **140b** of the sensor interface **140** and operably coupled to the central circuit board. The position sensor **136** can be coupled to the sensor interface **140** such that, in operation, the position sensor **136** detects and measures the radial distance of the sensor interface **140** from the center point of central opening **112**. As discussed with respect to FIGS. 4A and 4B, the guide pins **132** and position sensor **136** are disposed within openings of the carrier **120** and configured to move within the openings as the device **100** moves from an open to a closed configuration. Coupling features **138**, corresponding to the coupling features of the carrier **120** can be included in the sensor assembly **130**. In the example of FIGS. 6A and 6B, the coupling features

are retainer clips **138** fixed to the back surface **140b** of the sensor interface **140**. Each retainer clip **138** extends perpendicular from the back surface **140b** and contains a tab **139** at the distal-most end. The retainer clip **138** is configured to pass through an opening formed in the carrier **120** while the tab is configured to contact the outer surface of the carrier to limit the movement of the sensor interface **140** past a certain distance from the carrier **120**. Any other coupling mechanism known in the art can be used to couple the sensor assemblies **130** to the carrier **120**.

[0057] An example of a sensor interface **140** is illustrated in FIGS. 7A-7B. In some embodiments, the sensor interface **140** is the printed circuit board to which the light source and photodiode are mounted, in other embodiments, the sensor includes a housing **141** configured to house the light source **148** and the detector **145**. The housing **142** can include a contact surface **141**. The sensor assemblies can each comprise additional sensors operably connected to the central circuit board. For example, as shown in FIGS. 7A and 7B, a pressure transducer **143** and an associated receiver **144** are coupled to the housing **141** and configured to quantify the force of pressure between the skin and the sensor interface **140**. A temperature sensor **146** is mounted to the printed circuit board disposed within the housing **141** to measure the temperature of the appendage. Electrical components, such as the printed circuit board, are disposed within the housing such that contact surfaces of the light source **148**, detector **145**, and temperature sensor **146** contact the appendage. A plurality of openings **147** can be formed on the contact surface **141** of the housing **142** to allow contact surfaces of an LED **148**, photodiode **145**, or other sensor **146** disposed on the printed circuit board to contact the appendage.

[0058] The printed circuit board can be disposed within the housing **142** between the contact surface **141** and pressure transducer **143**. In some embodiments, the housing **142** can fully enclose the printed circuit board or the printed circuit board as well as the pressure transducer **143** and receiver **144**.

[0059] The light source **148** can be a LED array including green, red or infrared LEDs or any LED with a wavelength between about, for example, 400 nm and 1500 nm. Biological materials within the appendage absorb light of varying wavelengths. Using an array of varying LEDs allows the device **100** to capture an accurate signal from each material. For example, water and lipids absorb wavelengths beyond 1000 nm better than wavelengths below 1000 nm and blood absorbs wavelengths between 400 nm and 600 nm. Each detector **145** can be a single photodiode (PD) or a PD array, each configured to perform in a frequency range corresponding to the emitted frequencies from the light sources, for example, between 400 nm and 1500 nm (e.g., corresponding to the wavelengths of the LEDs **148**). Each PD **145** can be configured to measure signals in both reflective and transmittance modes. In embodiments where the light source **144** and the detectors **145** are mounted to a printed circuit board, the printed circuit board further includes an analog front end configured to acquire and condition the signals detected by the detectors **145**. In some examples, the analog front end includes a transimpedance amplifier, a buffer, and other signal amplification circuits and does not include analog filters. The absence of analog filters preserves the raw acquired signals, thereby allowing the integrity of the AC and DC components of the signals to be captured and used for processing.

Signal Acquisition and Signal Processing Examples

[0060] An example schematic of sensor assembly position of the previously disclosed device is illustrated in FIG. 8A. In the illustrated example, eight sensor assemblies are positioned at 45° intervals around the circumference of the device **100**. Each sensor assembly includes a LED **144a-h** and a PD **145a-h**. Any number of sensor assemblies between can be positioned within the circumference of the device at equal intervals around the inner circumference, though advantageously 3 or more are used to enable improved special reconstruction. Each assembly can lie on the same radial axis as an opposing assembly. The alignment of the sensor assemblies allows the device to measure signals in transmission mode, where the LED and PD are on the opposite sides of the subject, or reflective mode, where the LED and PD are on the same side of the subject.

[0061] An exemplary timing scheme for acquiring signals using the device **100** of the present disclosure is illustrated in FIG. **8B**. In general, the LEDs can be illuminated individually in sequential order. When a single LED is illuminated, pairs of photodiodes are sequentially sampled until all LEDs have been turned on and all photodiode pairs are samples for each LED. For example, in a device with eight sensor assemblies as shown in FIG. **9A**, a first LED **144a** positioned at the 0° position is illuminated for approximately 160 seconds. While the first LED **144a** is illuminated, pairs of photodiodes positioned on the same axis are sampled sequentially. In the present example, a pair of photodiodes **145a**, **145b** positioned at the 0° and 45° are sampled, then photodiodes **145c**, **145d** positioned at 90° and 135° ; photodiodes **145e**, **145f** positioned at 180° and 225° ; and photodiodes **145g**, **145h** positioned at 270° and 315° are sequentially sampled after. In a representative and non-limiting example, each photodiode pair can be sampled for approximately 40 seconds. Once all of the photodiode pairs are sampled, the first LED at the 0° position is turned off and the next LED positioned at the 45° position is illuminated and each pair of LEDs sampled for the first LED are again sequentially sampled for the next LED. The process continues until all LEDs are individually illuminated and each photodiode pair is sampled. In an embodiment of a device with eight sensors, this process results in 64 total signals. The process can be repeated for each wavelength LED of the PPG sensors.

[0062] In some embodiments, the PDs are sampled individually instead of in pairs. For example, while the LED **144a** at the 0° , each of the PDs **145a-h** can be sampled individually, all of the PDs can be sampled simultaneously, or any number of PDs can be sampled simultaneously. Once all of the PDs are sampled, the LED **144a** can be turned off, and the next LED **144b** is illuminated and all PDs **145a-h** are sampled. Although examples where the LEDs and PDs are illuminated and sampled sequentially in order of placement around the device are discussed, the LEDs and PDs can be illuminated and sampled in any order until a signal from each combination of LED and PD is acquired.

[0063] The printed circuit boards of each sensor can be connected to a central circuit board **150** configured to control the signal acquisition. An exemplary embodiment of a central circuit board **150** is illustrated in FIG. **9**. The illustrated central circuit board **150** can include a computing system such as a microcontroller **152**. The microcontroller can contain instructions for the device to acquire the desired signals. The central circuit board **150** can include a battery **151** to provide power to the device. The battery can be rechargeable through the use of charge inductors **153** and a charge circuit **154**. The central circuit **150** board can include a data storage module configured to store signals or data for further processing at a later time. The central circuit board **150** can further include a Bluetooth or Wi-Fi module **156** configured to transfer data from the device to a computing system or transfer instructions from the computing system to the device **100**. In some embodiments, the central circuit board **150** can include one or more additional sensors to acquire additional parameters such as an ambient temperature sensor **157**, or a gyroscope, an accelerometer, and a magnetometer **158** to sense position and movement of the device **100**.

[0064] FIG. **10** is a block diagram of an exemplary system **400** of the device **100**. In this example, the analog front end **410** of each sensor circuit board acquires and conditions a signal from the appendage and sends the signal to the central circuit board through a connection unit **420**. The signal can then be passed through an analog-to-digital converter (ADC) **430** and then to a microcontroller **440**. An ADC **430** with a resolution high enough to produce a waveform with distinguishable AC and DC components can be used. The microcontroller **440** can be configured to sample and control all LEDs and PDs within the sensor assemblies. For example, the microcontroller can be programmed with a timing scheme, such as the scheme of FIG. **8B**, to illuminate each LED and sample the signals from each PD. In a device with eight sensor assemblies, the microcontroller can acquire 64 signals at a sampling rate, for example, at a minimal of 200 Hz. In some examples, a signal to noise ratio (SNR) of the system **400** is at least 5:1. The microcontroller **440** can then send the data to a computing device or system **450** for further

processing. The computing system 450 can contain instructions to process the signals and provide real-time information as discussed below.

[0065] While examples shown herein include certain circuit components, these are representative and one skilled in the art will appreciate that these specific components can be replaced by functionally equivalent parts, as well as other versions with corresponding changes incorporated to the circuits to utilize them in an effectively similar manner to those presented herein.

[0066] The signals acquired by the devices of the present disclosure can be processed to obtain various static and dynamic measurements. The signals can be processed by software or a code of instructions located on a computing system 450. The computing system 450 can be a personal computer, or a handheld device such as a cell phone. In some embodiments, the device can be used in a clinical setting in conjunction with a larger computing system 450. The below actions can be done on either the computing system or ring device or some combination of both.

[0067] To measure physiological signals such as heart rate, heart rate variability, respiration, and blood oxygenation, the acquired data can be filtered and processed to extract the AC component and quasi-DC component (i.e. zero and very low frequency) of the signal. A low pass filter can be used to remove high-frequency noise from the raw signal. In some embodiments, a low pass filter with a cutoff of 5-10 Hz can be used. The AC component makes up the pulsatile arterial blood signal, while the quasi-DC component comprises signals originating from bone, tissue, venous blood, non-pulsatile arterial blood, and other tissue matter. Heart rate and heart rate variability can be derived from the AC component of the PPG signal, while respiration and blood oxygenation can be derived from the AC and quasi-DC components. The AC and quasi-DC components of the filtered signal can be separated by isolating the quasi-DC component using an envelope filter and subtracting the DC component from the filtered data, thus, isolating the AC component

[0068] The signals can be further processed using diffuse optical tomography (DOT) techniques to reconstruct a 2D or 3D image of the inner appendage to provide additional information about the static and dynamic signals. Accurate imaging of the inner appendix can provide the ability to isolate areas of interest within the appendage such as the main artery or superficial vessels.

[0069] Examples include the use of a continuous-wave DOT approach for near real-time imaging of the inner appendage. Various additional methodologies can be used to build an image reconstruction algorithm. Examples include reconstructions based on Rosenbrock's banana function, back projections, Monte Carlo simulations, machine-learning models, and other techniques known to one skilled in the art.

[0070] The mentioned reconstruction, or inverse, techniques are advantageous as computationally inexpensive approaches capable of giving metrics in real-time. Rosenbrock's banana function, back projections, and Monte Carlo simulations are relatively computationally inexpensive since the approaches taken can “smear” or project signal from the light source to the appropriate detector following an estimated path. The path can be estimated using the modified beer-lambert law and the diffuse equation. Interpolation image processing techniques can also be paired with a reconstruction algorithm to optimize resolution of the images further.

Machine Learning Examples

[0071] Examples of the present disclosure include the use of deep learning models to increase efficiency of the reconstruction techniques while also providing the ability to potentially train a model unsupervised based on in vivo data. The use of deep learning models can increase image resolution by taking a low-resolution image and recovering a high-resolution image through a technique referred to as super-resolution.

[0072] Examples include the use of a deep convolutional neural network that is configured to take an initial image estimate and optimize the resolution to enable hemoglobin and blood volume concentrations to be accurately identified. Example algorithms can reconstruct a single image to a higher resolution image and/or multiple images. In these examples, transfer learning can be employed to train the neural network using an existing datasets. In some embodiments, the

algorithm is trained through unsupervised learning. Additionally, interpolation can be utilized to increase the resolution of collected images. Example interpolation methods can include but are not limited to nearest neighbor, bilinear, bicubic, or cubic B-spline interpolation.

Additional Embodiments

[0073] Some exemplary methods disclosed can use two synced optical devices **100** of the present disclosure to acquire additional physiological measurements such pulse wave velocity. Two synced devices can be used or a single device, such as the device **100** can be modified to include two sensor carriers within a single outer case, each sensor carrier housing a row of sensor assemblies in a ring formation around the appendage, the rows of sensors parallel to each other. Pulse wave velocity can be calculated by measuring the time it takes the arterial pulse to travel a specific distance and then dividing the distance by the transit time. A first ring can send a radiofrequency wave to a second device. The time it takes for the wave to travel is divided by the wave speed to find the distance between the two devices. In other embodiments, a first ring can send a radiofrequency wave to a second ring and receive a reflected radio frequency wave back from the second ring. The arrival time is divided by 2 to find the distance between the two devices. In some methods, two rings can be placed on an appendage. The pulse wave velocity can then be determined using the distance between the devices and the signal arrive times for each device. In some method example, a single ring device can be used in conjunction with an armband instead of a second a ring device.

[0074] A charging platform can be provided with the devices of the present disclosure. The charging platform can function wired or wireless. In some embodiments, the charging platform can also function as a syncing platform to synchronize a plurality of devices for the purposes described above.

[0075] In some embodiments, the ring devices of the present disclosure include a single light source and fiber optic cables configured to transfer the light emitting from the light source to a plurality of locations. One with skill in the art with appreciate that any configuration capable of directing light to a location can be used in the device of the present disclosure.

[0076] In some embodiments, the ring devices of the present disclosure can be electrically connected to external equipment in a clinical setting to provide additional power to the device and computing to process more complicated signals. In these embodiments, the light sources can be connected fiber optic cables to direct light to the appendage. The main circuit board of the device or the sensor circuit boards can be electrically coupled to a computing system containing instructions to process the signals and provide information in real-time.

[0077] FIG. **11** provides for one non-limiting example of a computer system **1400** upon which the present disclosure can be built, performed, trained, etc. For example, referring to FIGS. **9** and **10**, the processing modules or processors **450** can be examples of the system **500** described herein. The system **500** can include a processor **510**, a memory **520**, a storage device **530**, and an input/output device **540**. Each of the components **510**, **520**, **530**, and **540** can be interconnected, for example, using a system bus **550**. The processor **510** can be capable of processing instructions for execution within the system **500**. The processor **510** can be a single-threaded processor, a multi-threaded processor, or similar device. The processor **510** can be capable of processing instructions stored in the memory **520** or on the storage device **530**. The processor **510** may execute operations such as calculation of a turbulence transition mode, calculation of a flow disturbance to suppress a turbulence transition mode, or adjustment of a predicted turbulence transition mode based on information received from one or more sensors measuring a fluid flow, among other features described in conjunction with the present disclosure, including any control logic associated with the operation of an active turbulence suppression system or device.

[0078] The memory **520** can store information within the system **500**. In some implementations, the memory **1420** can be a computer-readable medium. The memory **520** can, for example, be a volatile memory unit or a non-volatile memory unit. In some implementations, the memory **520**

can store information related conduit geometries, fluid flow parameters (predicted or measured), turbulence transition mode(s), any information related to the calculation of the turbulence transition mode, among other information.

[0079] The storage device **530** can be capable of providing mass storage for the system **500**. In some implementations, the storage device **530** can be a non-transitory computer-readable medium. The storage device **530** can include, for example, a hard disk device, an optical disk device, a solid-state drive, a flash drive, magnetic tape, or some other large capacity storage device. The storage device **530** may alternatively be a cloud storage device, e.g., a logical storage device including multiple physical storage devices distributed on a network and accessed using a network. In some implementations, the information stored on the memory **520** can also or instead be stored on the storage device **530**.

[0080] The input/output device **540** can provide input/output operations for the system **500**. In some implementations, the input/output device **540** can include one or more of network interface devices (e.g., an Ethernet card), a serial communication device (e.g., an RS-232 10 port), and/or a wireless interface device (e.g., a short-range wireless communication device, an 802.11 card, a 3G wireless modem, or a 4G wireless modem). In some implementations, the input/output device **1440** can include driver devices configured to receive input data and send output data to other input/output devices, e.g., a keyboard, a printer, and display devices. In some implementations, mobile computing devices, mobile communication devices, and other devices can be used.

[0081] In some implementations, the system **500** can be a microcontroller. A microcontroller is a device that contains multiple elements of a computer system in a single electronics package. For example, the single electronics package could contain the processor **510**, the memory **520**, the storage device **530**, and input/output devices **540**.

[0082] Although an example processing system has been described above, implementations of the subject matter and the functional operations described above can be implemented in other types of digital electronic circuitry, or in computer software, firmware, and/or hardware, including the structures disclosed in this specification and their structural equivalents, or in combinations of one or more of them. Implementations of the subject matter described in this specification can be implemented as one or more computer program products, i.e., one or more modules of computer program instructions encoded on a tangible program carrier, for example a computer-readable medium, for execution by, or to control the operation of, a processing system. The computer readable medium can be a machine-readable storage device, a machine-readable storage substrate, a memory device, a composition of matter effecting a machine-readable propagated signal, or a combination of one or more of them.

[0083] Various embodiments of the present disclosure may be implemented at least in part in any conventional computer programming language. For example, some embodiments may be implemented in a procedural programming language (e.g., “C”), or in an object-oriented programming language (e.g., “C++”). Other embodiments of the invention may be implemented as a pre-configured, stand-alone hardware element and/or as preprogrammed hardware elements (e.g., application specific integrated circuits, FPGAs, and digital signal processors), or other related components.

[0084] The term “computer system” may encompass all apparatus, devices, and machines for processing data, including by way of example a programmable processor, a computer, or multiple processors or computers. A processing system can include, in addition to hardware, code that creates an execution environment for the computer program in question, e.g., code that constitutes processor firmware, a protocol stack, a database management system, an operating system, or a combination of one or more of them.

[0085] A computer program (also known as a program, software, software application, script, executable logic, or code) can be written in any form of programming language, including compiled or interpreted languages, or declarative or procedural languages, and it can be deployed

in any form, including as a standalone program or as a module, component, subroutine, or other unit suitable for use in a computing environment. A computer program does not necessarily correspond to a file in a file system. A program can be stored in a portion of a file that holds other programs or data (e.g., one or more scripts stored in a markup language document), in a single file dedicated to the program in question, or in multiple coordinated files (e.g., files that store one or more modules, sub programs, or portions of code). A computer program can be deployed to be executed on one computer or on multiple computers that are located at one site or distributed across multiple sites and interconnected by a communication network.

[0086] Such implementation may include a series of computer instructions fixed either on a tangible, non-transitory medium, such as a computer readable medium. The series of computer instructions can embody all or part of the functionality previously described herein with respect to the system. Computer readable media suitable for storing computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile or volatile memory, media and memory devices, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, e.g., EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks, e.g., internal hard disks or removable disks or magnetic tapes; magneto optical disks; and CD-ROM and DVD-ROM disks. The processor and the memory can be supplemented by, or incorporated in, special purpose logic circuitry. The components of the system can be interconnected by any form or medium of digital data communication, e.g., a communication network. Examples of communication networks include a local area network (“LAN”) and a wide area network (“WAN”), e.g., the Internet.

[0087] Those skilled in the art should appreciate that such computer instructions can be written in a number of programming languages for use with many computer architectures or operating systems. Furthermore, such instructions may be stored in any memory device, such as semiconductor, magnetic, optical or other memory devices, and may be transmitted using any communications technology, such as optical, infrared, microwave, or other transmission technologies.

[0088] Among other ways, such a computer program product may be distributed as a removable medium with accompanying printed or electronic documentation (e.g., shrink-wrapped software), preloaded with a computer system (e.g., on system ROM or fixed disk), or distributed from a server or electronic bulletin board over the network (e.g., the Internet or World Wide Web). In fact, some embodiments may be implemented in a software-as-a-service model (“SAAS”) or cloud-computing model. Of course, some embodiments of the present disclosure may be implemented as a combination of both software (e.g., a computer program product) and hardware. Still other embodiments of the present disclosure are implemented as entirely hardware, or entirely software.

[0089] Examples of the above-described embodiments can include the following:

1. A wearable optical device comprising: [0090] a ring configured to surround an appendage, the ring comprising an outer surface and an inner surface facing the appendage; [0091] a plurality of light sources disposed circumferentially about the inner surface and configured to direct light towards the appendage; [0092] a plurality of detectors disposed circumferentially about the inner surface, each detector configured to receive light from the appendage, the light being reflected from and/or transmitted through the appendage from at least one of the plurality of light sources; and [0093] a circuit board disposed within the ring and operatively connected to each of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors, [0094] wherein the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are configured to operate together to generate data suitable for conducting diffuse optical tomography on the appendage.
2. The device of example 1, wherein the device defines an open position wherein the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are disposed proximal to the inner surface and a closed position where the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are contacting the appendage, the device being operable to move between the open position and the closed position.
3. The device of examples 1 to 2, wherein each of the plurality of light sources comprises a contact surface configured to contact the appendage and each of the plurality of detectors comprises a

contact surface configured to contact the appendage, wherein the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors are arranged in pairs.

4. The device of examples 1 to 3, wherein each light source and detector of each pair is disposed within a common housing.

5. The device of examples 1 to 4, further comprising a carrier disposed within a recess formed in the inner surface of the ring, the carrier configured to couple the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors to the ring.

6. The device of examples 4 to 5, further comprising a plurality of biasing mechanisms each configured to bias a respective one of the common housings towards the appendage.

7. The device of examples 4 to 6, wherein each common housing is configured to move along a respective radial axis and is prevented from rotating relative to the carrier.

8. The device of examples 1 to 7, comprising a plurality of pressure sensors, each pressure sensor configured to measure pressure of the appendage against the contact surfaces of at least one of a respective one of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors.

9. The device of examples 1 to 8, comprising a plurality of position sensors, each position sensor configured to measure radial deflection of at least one of the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors by the appendage.

10. The device of examples 1 to 9, wherein the plurality of light sources comprises eight light sources disposed at equal intervals about the circumference of the inner surface, and wherein the plurality of detectors comprises eight detectors disposed at equal intervals about the circumference of the inner surface.

11. The device of examples 1 to 10, wherein each light source of the plurality of light sources comprises an array of light-emitting diodes, each array comprising a plurality of individual light-emitting diodes each configured to emit light in a different wavelength.

12. The device of examples 1 to 11, comprising a microcontroller configured to cause the emission of light from each of the plurality of light sources and receive the data from each of the plurality of detectors.

13. The device of examples 1 to 12, comprising a wireless transmitter configured to transmit the data.

14. The device of examples 1 to 13, further at least one of: a skin temperature sensor, an ambient temperature sensor, or a sensor configured to measure movement of the device.

15. A method of obtaining a signal from a subject comprising: [0095] given a wearable optical device disposed around an appendage, the device comprising a plurality of light sources and a plurality of detectors disposed circumferentially around the appendage; [0096] emitting light from one of the plurality of light sources individually; [0097] receiving signals from each of the plurality of detectors, [0098] repeating the emitting and receiving for each of the plurality of light sources; and [0099] generating data from the received signals, the data being suitable for conducting 2D or 3D diffuse optical tomography on the appendage.

16. The method of example 15, further comprising moving the plurality of light sources and the plurality of detectors towards the appendage until they contact the appendage.

17. The method of examples 15 to 16, wherein the signals are received from two or more photodiodes at a time.

18. The method of examples 15 to 17, further comprising: [0100] receiving by a processor, the data from the device of disposed around the appendage; [0101] reconstructing an image of the appendage using the data and diffuse optical tomography techniques; [0102] isolating a biosignal from an internal structure within the appendage; and [0103] providing physiological information based on the biosignal.

19. The method of example 18, wherein the biosignal comprises a dynamic signal and the physiological information comprises at least one of: blood volume changes, blood oxygenation, blood velocity, pulse wave velocity, or blood flow.

20. The method of examples 18 to 19, wherein the biosignal comprises a static signal and the physiological information comprises at least one of: bone location, tendon location, fat concentration, or water concentration.
21. The method of examples 18 to 20, wherein the image is reconstructed and the physiological information is provided in real-time.
22. The method of examples 18 to 21, wherein the internal structure is a main artery of the appendage.
23. The method of examples 18 to 22, wherein the data is processed using a deep learning model to obtain the reconstructed image of the appendage.

[0104] One skilled in the art will readily appreciate that the present disclosure is well adapted to carry out the objects and obtain the ends and advantages mentioned, as well as those inherent therein. The present disclosure described herein are presently representative of preferred embodiments, are exemplary, and are not intended as limitations on the scope of the present disclosure. Changes therein and other uses will occur to those skilled in the art which are encompassed within the spirit of the present disclosure as defined by the scope of the claims.

Claims

1. A wearable optical device comprising a ring configured to surround an appendage of a user and including a stationary section and a rotatable section rotatably coupled to the stationary section, the ring defining an outer surface and an inner surface opposite the outer surface adapted to face toward a skin surface of the appendage, and a plurality of sensor assemblies disposed circumferentially about the inner surface of the ring and configured to measure physiological signals of the user, wherein, in response to rotation of the rotatable section of the ring relative to the stationary section of the ring, the wearable optical device is configured to move between (i) an open configuration in which the plurality of sensor assemblies moves outwardly away from a centerpoint of the ring to be disposed proximal to the inner surface of the ring and (ii) a closed configuration in which the plurality of sensor assemblies moves inwardly toward the centerpoint of the ring.
2. The wearable optical device of claim 1, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies includes a sensor interface, a light source coupled to the sensor interface and configured to direct light toward the appendage, and a light detector coupled to the sensor interface and configured to receive light from the appendage.
3. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein the light source of each of the plurality of sensor assemblies defines a contact surface configured to contact the skin surface of the appendage and the light detector of each of the plurality of sensor assemblies defines a contact surface configured to contact the skin surface of the appendage.
4. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies further includes a biasing mechanism coupled to the sensor interface and configured to bias the corresponding sensor assembly toward the skin surface of the appendage.
5. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies further includes a position sensor coupled to the sensor interface and configured to measure a radial distance between the corresponding sensor assembly and the centerpoint of the ring.
6. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies further includes a pressure transducer coupled to the sensor interface and configured to quantify a force of pressure between the skin surface and the sensor interface.
7. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies further includes a temperature sensor coupled to the sensor interface and configured to measure a temperature of the appendage.
8. The wearable optical device of claim 2, wherein the light source and the light detector of each of

the plurality of sensor assemblies are configured to operate together to generate data suitable for conducting diffuse optical tomography on the appendage.

9. The wearable optical device of claim 1, wherein the inner surface of the ring is formed to define a recess that extends into the inner surface of the ring toward the outer surface of the ring.

10. The wearable optical device of claim 9, further comprising a carrier disposed within the recess, and wherein the plurality of sensor assemblies is coupled to the carrier.

11. The wearable optical device of claim 10, wherein the stationary section of the ring is fixed to the carrier and the rotatable section of the ring is configured to rotate around the carrier.

12. The wearable optical device of claim 10, wherein the carrier is formed to include a plurality of openings circumferentially spaced apart from one another about the carrier.

13. The wearable optical device of claim 12, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies includes a sensor interface and a retainer coupled to the sensor interface to extend toward the inner surface of the ring, and wherein the retainer of each of the plurality of sensor assemblies is received in a corresponding one of the plurality of openings of the carrier to couple each of the plurality of sensor assemblies to the carrier.

14. A method comprising providing a ring configured to surround an appendage of a user, the ring including a stationary section and a rotatable section rotatably coupled to the stationary section, coupling a plurality of sensor assemblies circumferentially about an inner surface of the ring, rotating the rotatable section of the ring relative to the stationary section of the ring in a first direction to cause the plurality of sensor assemblies to move outwardly away from a centerpoint of the ring to be disposed proximal to the inner surface of the ring, rotating the rotatable section of the ring relative to the stationary section of the ring in a second direction opposite the first direction to cause the plurality of sensor assemblies to move inwardly toward the centerpoint of the ring, and measuring physiological signals of the user with the plurality of sensor assemblies.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the step of rotating the rotatable section of the ring relative to the stationary section of the ring in a second direction includes contacting a skin surface of the appendage with the plurality of sensor assemblies.

16. The method of claim 14, wherein each of the plurality of sensor assemblies includes a light source and a light detector.

17. The method of claim 16, further comprising emitting light from the light source of one of the plurality of sensor assemblies individually.

18. The method of claim 17, further comprising, after the step of emitting light, receiving signals from the light detector of each of the plurality of sensor assemblies.

19. The method of claim 18, further comprising repeating the steps of emitting and receiving for the light source of each of the plurality of sensor assemblies.

20. The method of claim 19, further comprising generating data from the received signals, the data being suitable for conducting 2D or 3D diffuse optical tomography on the appendage.
